

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Hire Me!

A hacker who calls himself 'Apocalypse' defaced Microsoft UK's Web site late on the night of July 5, with a message in support of Venezuelan hacker 'RaFa'. Defacement archive Zone-H reported that the well-known defacer hacked into Microsoft's UK site (microsoft.co.uk) and uploaded a picture with the message "FREE RAFA - HACK IS NOT A CRIME".

The site was soon restored, and the offending GIF removed. But in an interesting development, the following week, Apocalypse wrote to *The Inquirer* suggesting Microsoft hire him as well as RaFa. He

said he just wanted to show Microsoft that any server or any company is vulnerable.

"As long people build something, somebody else is two steps ahead," he said.

Apocalypse also implied that if he had the new X-Box 360 with a lot of games, he would not have done it.

"Remember, I don't damage or erase or destroy anything; just post a message of support of my friend RaFa. They are charging him with a thing he didn't do and that's why I piss up," he said. He added: "If Microsoft can give and my friend RaFa a job, we can make (sic) sure it will never happen again."

I Want My Game Items!

Battles for rights over computer game accounts are becoming more vicious. According to the *Chongqing Business Post*, a Mr Wang and Ms Ye from Huibei in China fell in love last September on Shanda's online game *Legend of Mir 2*. Wang romantically saved Ye's character from being killed by another player. They were soon married, but the real-life marriage didn't work out.

The couple decided to get a divorce in June. During their

marriage, they jointly played over ten *Mir 2* accounts, attaining level 40 to 50 statuses for all of them. That, apparently, is pretty good. The characters and virtual items are estimated to be worth 40,000 to 50,000 Yuan (approximately Rs 2,36,000).

The divorce has taken an ugly turn: Wang told the court that Ye can keep the apartment and all he wants is the accounts and virtual items. But Ye wants to split the apartment and game items equally.

Made In Japan

Celebopedia (www.celebopedia.com), the Internet's leading celebrity encyclopaedia, recently announced the 10 most-searched-for celebrities for the week of July 4 to July 10. Maria Sharapova led all

searches for a third straight week in the aftermath of Wimbledon. The record is five straight weeks by *Herbie* actress Lindsay Lohan.

Angelina Jolie came in second place on news of her new adoption, while *Dukes Of Hazzard* starlet Jessica Simpson came in third amidst controversy surrounding the film's release.

Interest in Sharapova extends offline: a Japanese firm has come up with pillows shaped in the form of her breasts and lap. The breast pillow by the firm Sharanpowan is made with a cover in the style of a tennis shirt that can be removed to reveal more intimate details. The breast pillow costs \$17 (Rs 740), while the lap pillow costs \$29 (Rs 1,265). Apparently, the Japanese find the lower part of Sharapova's body more attractive.



We've Seen The Screenshots

We reported last month that a mod of the game *Grand Theft Auto: San Andreas* contains sexually explicit material. Now, the Australian Office of Film and Literature Classification is planning an examination into claims that the game becomes sexually explicit if players download and install the mod. According to *The Sydney Morning Herald*, if the claims were true, the game would be banned.

The mod was first noted

by a US media watchdog group, the National Institute on the Media and the Family, who wanted the game banned, saying that the plot is objectionable as it is.

Rockstar Games, which made the game, is not commenting on whether its programmers created the sex scenes and whether the mods just unlocked them.

But hey, the sex screenshots were posted on the Web. Why an inquiry is required, we don't understand.

3-Easy-Steps to Freebies!

- 1 Log on to www.thinkdigit.com/digitpatron to register.
- 2 Enter this 16-digit code and score points (you will find your code at this place every issue)
- 3 Your points get added every month and can be redeemed for exciting gifts!

